YOUR NAME

# Example Cookbook

1 recipes · updated November 2, 2026

# Rankings

| # | DISH | SCORE | GUT | COOKED |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Red Wine Braised Chuck Roast | **8.0** | **4/5** | 2026-11-01 |

BRAISE · 2026-11-01

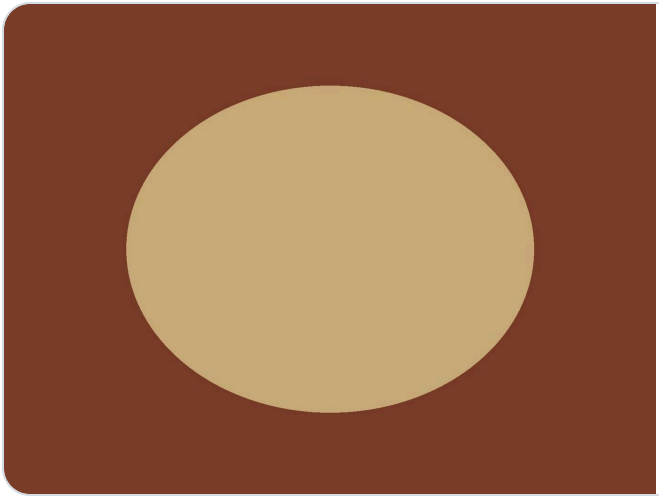
# Red Wine Braised Chuck Roast

Chuck roast seared hard, then braised in red wine and beef broth until it shreds.
Rustic sauce with the vegetables left in, spooned over mashed potatoes.

French-American | **5** servings | **30 min** active | **4 hr** total | Easy | Dinner **6:30 PM**

AUTHENTICITY

Built on the boeuf bourguignon method: hard sear, tomato paste and flour cooked into the fond, wine reduced before the broth goes in.



COOKED 2026-11-01

**8.0** / 10 · #1 of 1

Gut rating 4 / 5

Rich sauce. Boxed mash worked fine.

**Next time:** More garlic.

## Grocery list

Pantry items are marked to confirm. Everything else is a buy.

### MEAT 1

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Boneless chuck roast BUY<br>Look for even marbling and a thick piece. | 3.5 lb |

### PRODUCE 6

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ | Yellow onions BUY | 2 medium |
| ☐ | Carrots BUY | 4 |
| ☐ | Celery BUY | 3 stalks |
| ☐ | Garlic BUY | 4 cloves |
| ☐ | Fresh thyme BUY | 4 sprigs |
| ☐ | Fresh rosemary BUY | 1 sprig |

| PANTRY | 10 |
|---|---|
| ☐ Dry red wine BUY<br>Cabernet or Merlot you would drink. Skip cooking wine. | 1.5 cups |
| ☐ Beef broth BUY | 1.5 cups |
| ☐ Tomato paste CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 2 tbsp |
| ☐ All-purpose flour CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 2 tbsp |
| ☐ Worcestershire sauce CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 1 tbsp |
| ☐ Dijon mustard CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 1 tbsp |
| ☐ Bay leaves CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 2 |
| ☐ Kosher salt CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 2 tsp + to taste |
| ☐ Black pepper CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 1 tsp |
| ☐ Olive oil CONFIRM YOU HAVE | 2 tbsp |

# Before you cook

Most of this dish is oven time. Start about 4 hours before dinner.

GAME PLAN

| | |
|---|---|
| **2:15 PM** | Pull the roast from the fridge. Chop vegetables. |
| **2:30 PM** | Oven on to 325°F. Sear the beef. |
| **3:00 PM** | Pot goes in the oven. |
| **6:00 PM** | Check tenderness. Make mashed potatoes. |
| **6:30 PM** | Serve. |

EQUIPMENT

- [ ] Dutch oven, 6 qt
  A smaller pot needs the roast cut into more pieces.
- [ ] Cutting board and chef's knife
- [ ] Tongs
- [ ] Wooden spoon
- [ ] Two forks for shredding

DO THESE WHILE COOKING

- Make the mashed potatoes during the last 30 minutes of the braise.

P1

## Chop the vegetables

15 min

| | |
|---|---|
| **2** | yellow onions |
| **4** | carrots |
| **3 stalks** | celery |
| **4 cloves** | garlic |

1. Chop the onions into 1/2-inch pieces.
2. Cut carrots and celery into 1-inch chunks. Big pieces survive 3 hours in the oven.
3. Smash the garlic cloves with the flat of the knife and peel.

# Cook

READ FIRST

- Pat the beef **completely dry** before searing. Wet meat steams and never browns.

## 1 Season and sear the beef

2:30 PM · 15 min · Medium-high

| | |
|---|---|
| **3.5 lb** | chuck roast (cut into 3 or 4 chunks) |
| **2 tsp** | kosher salt |
| **1 tsp** | black pepper |
| **2 tbsp** | olive oil |

1. Heat the oven to 325°F.
2. Pat the beef dry and season all sides with the salt and pepper.
3. Heat the oil in the Dutch oven until it shimmers.
4. Sear 4 to 5 minutes per side without moving it. Work in batches so pieces don't touch.
5. Move the beef to a plate.

**DONE WHEN** Every side has a deep brown crust. Pale gray means it needs more time.

> If the meat sticks, it is not ready to flip. It releases once the crust forms.

## 2 Build the base

2:45 PM · 7 min · Medium

| | |
|---|---|
| **2** | chopped onions |
| **4** | carrots, chunked |
| **3 stalks** | celery, chunked |
| **4 cloves** | garlic, smashed |
| **2 tbsp** | tomato paste |
| **2 tbsp** | flour |

1. Lower the heat. Add onions, carrots and celery. Cook 5 minutes, scraping the bottom.
2. Add garlic, tomato paste and flour. Stir 1 to 2 minutes until the paste turns brick red.

**HOW TO: COOK OUT THE FLOUR**

1. Stir constantly so the flour coats the vegetables.
2. It should smell toasty, not raw. This is what thickens the sauce later without extra work.

## 3 Deglaze and braise

2:55 PM | 3 to 3.5 hr | 325°F oven

| | |
|---|---|
| **1.5 cups** | dry red wine |
| **1.5 cups** | beef broth |
| **1 tbsp** | Worcestershire |
| **1 tbsp** | Dijon mustard |
| **2** | bay leaves |
| **4 + 1** | thyme sprigs + rosemary sprig |

1. Pour in the wine and scrape up every browned bit. Simmer 3 minutes.
2. Add broth, Worcestershire, Dijon and herbs.
3. Return the beef and plate juices. Liquid should come halfway up the meat.
4. Cover and bake 3 to 3.5 hours.

**DONE WHEN** A fork twists into the meat with no resistance.

## 4 Shred and finish

6:05 PM | 15 min | Medium (stovetop)

| | |
|---|---|
| **to taste** | kosher salt |

1. Remove bay leaves and herb stems. Skim fat off the top.
2. Shred the beef in the pot with two forks.
3. If the sauce is thin, simmer uncovered 10 minutes. Salt to taste.

# Plating

- Wide shallow bowl. Mashed potatoes first, swooped with the back of a spoon to make a well.
- Spoon beef and vegetables into the well, then extra sauce over the top.
- Finish with chopped parsley or thyme leaves for color.

# Tips from the pros

- Leftovers taste better the next day.

# If something goes wrong

| | |
|---|---|
| **Sauce too thin** | Simmer uncovered 10 to 15 minutes. |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Meat still tough at 3.5 hours** | It needs more time, not less. Back in for 30 minutes. |

SOURCES

- Well Plated: Braised Beef